



Scag Scapes Growth Blueprint

24-month proforma and five-year plan

Two crews at 900 LF a month, a recurring Drain Check book, and a business that runs on data - grown in a logical, safe order - then a third and fourth crew, each earned before it is bought.

Prepared for Charlie Mascagni, Scag Scapes LLC

By Ned Pearson - Baton Rouge - September 2026

Companion workbook: Scag-Scapes-Proforma.xlsx - every number here is a formula there; change the yellow cells and both move. Your proposal template stays exactly as it is. The software feeds it numbers and the Measure map; it does not replace it.

The plan in one page

\$757K

Year 1 revenue in the base case (one crew ramping, second crew from month 7)

\$1.11M

Year 2 revenue with two crews at 900 LF and 150+ Drain Check customers

\$373K

Year 2 operating profit after a \$6,000/month owner draw, marketing, and the Crew 2 loan

150

Drain Check maintenance customers at month 24 - the recurring, sellable part of the business

Charlie is at about 400 LF a month with one three-man crew and roughly \$1,500 of revenue per crew-day. His goal is 800-1,000 LF a month per crew, two crews, 50% margin after labor, materials and fuel, selling to homeowners 50-75 within 20 miles of 70808. The numbers say the goal is reachable in about ten months without borrowing against the house, if five things happen in this order:

- **Answer every lead in 60 seconds and quote the same day.** Command does this today. It is the single biggest lever: 27% of home-service calls go unanswered and 85% of those callers never call back.
- **Buy leads where the 50-75 homeowner actually is:** Google Local Services Ads for people searching 'french drain Baton Rouge' (\$59/lead, 39.5% book rate) and Facebook - 79% of 50-64s and 69% of 65+ use it - for the neighbors who did not know they needed you yet. Budget starts at \$1,800/month and scales with the second crew.
- **Sell the Drain Check plan on every quote and every warranty walk.** Water-jet clean plus flow test, \$249 a year, 72% margin, 40% attach rate. It fills slow weeks, makes customers permanent, and turns a job shop into a company with recurring revenue - the kind that sells for a multiple.
- **Start Crew 2 in month 7, rent-first.** Trigger: Crew 1 has done 900 LF for three straight months and the backlog is over four weeks. Crew 1 already owns its trailer, skid steer and mini excavator. Crew 2 gets its own set: trailer, truck and tools bought on day one; the mini-ex and skid steer rented for 90 days and bought (80% financed) once Crew 2 hits target twice. Cash stays within a few thousand dollars of the opening balance at its lowest and grows from month 3.
- **Run the company on the Monday dashboard.** Speed-to-lead, cost per lead by channel, close rate, LF per crew, margin per job, plan attach rate, cash. Every lever in this plan is a setting in the software, not a rebuild.

Where the numbers stand today, and what they imply

Charlie's figure	What the model does with it	What it implies
50% margin after materials, fuel and labor; labor ~32%, materials + fuel ~20%	Materials + fuel 20% of revenue. Labor is NOT a percentage - it is the crew's wages x hours x burden, the same whether the crew installs 400 LF or 900 LF (labor method 2, switchable to a flat 32%)	At 900 LF and \$50/LF the model reproduces Charlie's rules: labor 31%, gross margin 49%. Every 100 LF job puts \$2,455 in gross profit.
Crew paid \$20-25/hr, 3 per crew	3 x 173 h x \$22.50 + a \$3/hr lead premium, x 1.14 burden = \$13,904 per crew-month. Wage, premium, burden, hours and overtime are all yellow cells.	Today, at ~400 LF/month, that crew is 44% of revenue. At 900 LF it is 31% . Same crew, same wages - the feet per day are the whole difference. That is why the readiness gate and breakdown flow are in the plan, not just marketing.
Currently ~400 LF/month; an average job day is ~\$1,500 of revenue	Month 1 = 400 LF: about 9 crew-days on drains at \$50/LF plus 12 days of other work at \$1,000/day = \$1,509 per crew-day - the model starts where Charlie is	Growth is filling every crew-day with drainage feet: 43 LF/day x 21 days = 900 LF. Crew 1 ramps 400 to 900 by month 6; one crew at 900 LF = \$45,000 revenue and \$22,096 gross profit per month.
Two crews; Crew 1 owns trailer, skid steer, mini-ex	Crew 2 starts month 7 with its own set: trailer, truck, tools bought at start; mini-ex and skid steer rented 3 months, then bought (80% financed, 60 months)	Two crews at target = about \$90,000/month. \$138,500 of purchases, \$27,700 in down payments, ~\$2,300/month in loan payments once everything is owned.
Water-jet maintenance, yearly or every 2 years	Drain Check plan: \$249/visit, \$70 cost, annual	\$895 gross profit per customer over five years before any referral.
Moasure on every proposal	CSV import into the quote builder (built this week); PDF attached to your template	Run length and fall come off the survey, not a tape; the 1% slope check is automatic.

Break-even with one crew is 640 LF a month - 71% of one crew's target. Everything past that is profit, and that is why the plan can afford to grow carefully.

The market inside 20 miles of 70808

456,180

people in East Baton Rouge Parish (2025 est.), 17.4% age 65+ (Census QuickFacts)

59.3%

owner-occupied; 210,707 housing units; median home \$248,800 (Census, 2020-24)

\$411K+

median home value in 70808 itself; 56% owner-occupied; heavy 1970-1989 housing stock (City-Data / ACS 2024)

60.65"

of rain a year - about double the U.S. average (usclimatedata.com)

How big is the pond

Owner-occupied homes in EBR alone: roughly 125,000 (210,707 units x 59.3%). Nationally about a third of owner households are headed by someone 50-74, so the 50-75 owner segment inside the parish is on the order of **40,000 homes** before adding the Ascension, Livingston and West Baton Rouge portions of the 20-mile circle (assumption, flagged in the workbook). Two crews at target complete about 216 jobs a year - **half of one percent** of that segment. This plan is capacity-constrained, not demand-constrained; the job is to be the company they find first.

Why 50-75 in this ZIP is the right customer

- They own, they have equity, and their houses were built when drainage was an afterthought - the 1970-89 stock in 70808 is exactly where original drains have failed.
- They pay for a person who shows up, a printed proposal with a map, and a warranty with a term. All three are Charlie's strengths and none of the seven competitors offers them (see the app's Competitive edge page).
- They are on Facebook: 79% of 50-64s and 69% of 65+ (Pew, 2025). Only 35% and 19% are on Instagram - Instagram is for the 40-year-old daughter who finds the contractor for her parents, not the primary channel.
- They call. The phone is the channel, which is why the 60-second text-back plus a same-day call-back is the core of the growth engine - not a web funnel.
- The parish cannot help them: \$150M+ of drainage work waiting on FEMA (WBRZ, Aug 2026) and years of unanswered 311 complaints (WAFB, May 2026).

The growth engine: leads to installed feet

Channel	Monthly budget	Cost per lead	Leads that book an estimate	Jobs / month (at 70% close)	Why it works for this customer
Google Local Services Ads (drain / sewer, 20-mi radius)	\$900 (x1.6 with Crew 2)	\$59 (SearchLight, Feb 2026)	50% (industry book rate 39.5%)	~5	Highest intent: the yard is flooding right now and they typed it into Google. Google-guaranteed badge matters to this age group.
Facebook + Instagram ads (age 50-75, homeowners, 20 mi of 70808)	\$600 from month 2 (x1.6 with Crew 2)	\$55 (landscaping \$45-80, 2026)	30%	~2	Reach the neighbor whose yard floods every spring but has not searched yet. Rain-day creative. Instant text-back keeps these from going cold.
Organic: reviews, referrals, Google Business Profile, parish pages, rain trigger	\$300 content	near \$0	65%	~3 growing 6%/mo	Reviews compound. Every completed job asks for one; every warranty walk asks for a referral; every rain event texts past customers' neighbors.
Total	\$1,800 -> \$2,700	~\$45 blended	~45% book, then 70% close	~10 -> 16	About 1,000 LF a month of demand at 100 LF per job (\$5,000 all-in) - matched to one crew, then scaled to two.

Close rate is Charlie's number. The model uses 70% of estimates run turning into sold jobs - his figure - as one yellow cell on the Assumptions tab. Change it and every channel, month, scenario and the lead count needed all move. Leads-to-estimate rates are per channel and also adjustable.

The rules that make paid leads pay

- **60 seconds.** Every lead gets a text with the price range and two open estimate slots before a human is involved. Call-back inside 5 minutes when Charlie is free; the app shows who is waiting.
- **Same-day quote with the Moasure map** in Charlie's own template. The map is the close - nobody else in the market brings one.
- **Track cost per job, not cost per lead.** The dashboard shows it by channel every Monday; a channel that goes over \$500 per job for two weeks gets its budget moved.
- **Do not buy leads you cannot install.** The proforma caps backlog at one month of capacity; beyond that the customer calls the next company. When backlog passes four weeks, the answer is Crew 2, not more ads.

Facebook first, Instagram present, YouTube for proof

Platform	Reach in the target (Pew 2025)	Role	What to post	Cadence
Facebook	79% of 50-64 - 69% of 65+	Primary. Paid + organic + neighborhood groups.	Rain-day 'is your yard holding water?' posts within 12 hours of a storm; before/after with the Moasure map; 60-second explainers ('why the water sits at your slab'); customer thank-yous with names (permission); crew at work; the Drain Check plan.	3 organic posts/week; 1 boosted rain post per event; ads always on
Instagram	35% of 50-64 - 19% of 65+	Secondary. The adult children and realtors.	Same before/after as Reels; time-lapse of a trench day; 'the map' carousel.	2/week, cross-posted from Facebook
YouTube	74% of 50-64 - 55% of 65+	Proof library, linked from quotes and the website.	One 3-minute walkthrough per month: a real job from flooded yard to flow test. Searchable: 'french drain Baton Rouge'.	1/month
Google Business Profile	The map pack - where 'french drain near me' is won	Where reviews live.	Photos weekly, a post after every rain, Q&A; answered, services and price range listed.	Weekly
Nextdoor	Parish-level word of mouth, older skew	Recommendations engine.	Business page; ask happy customers to recommend; answer drainage questions in the feed.	As it comes

Ad targeting and creative that fits the demographic

- Targeting: 20-mile radius of 70808, ages 50-75, homeowners; exclude renters and under-35. Lead form with two fields (name, phone) - the app calls back; no long forms.
- Creative: a real Baton Rouge yard, Charlie's face, the printed map, the warranty line. No stock photos. Large type. The word 'engineer' and the phrase '1-year workmanship warranty' in every ad.
- Impact the model expects: about 11 leads and 2 jobs a month at \$600, rising with Crew 2 - roughly \$8,400 of monthly install revenue from a \$600 spend, plus the plan customers those jobs become. Measured, not assumed: every lead is tagged by source in the app.

Drain Check: the recurring book that sells the company

\$249

per annual visit; Angi 2026 hydro jetting \$350-600 (avg \$475) - priced under market on purpose

72%

gross margin per visit: one tech, two hours, jetter already owned, fuel and water (\$70 cost)

\$895

five-year gross profit per plan customer, before the referral one in four of them sends

\$29K

year-2 plan revenue at 40% attach on new installs plus 15% of past customers

How it is sold - three moments, all automated

- **On the quote:** a line under the warranty - 'Drain Check: we come back every year, jet the lines, test the flow, \$249.' Pre-checked on the proposal; the customer removes it rather than adds it.
- **At the 11-month warranty walk:** the app schedules the walk, the tech does the first jetting as part of it, and offers the plan at the door. This is also the referral ask.
- **After every rain event:** past customers without a plan get one text: 'Your drain is 2 years old - want it jetted before the next storm?'

Why it matters more than its revenue line

- **Cash flow smoothing:** plans are scheduled into the weeks installs are thin (August heat, December). A crew member with the jetter does 4-5 visits a day - \$806 of gross profit on a day that would otherwise be idle.
- **Retention and referrals:** a customer you see every year refers; one you saw once does not.
- **Enterprise value:** a contractor with 150-300 recurring-service customers and a documented process is bought as a business, not as a truck and a mini-ex. Recurring revenue is what a buyer pays a multiple for.
- **Scalable:** it does not need Charlie. It needs a checklist (in the app), a tech, and the jetter. That is the first job a Crew 2 lead can own.

Crew 2 without betting the company

The trigger, not the date

Crew 2 starts when three things are true at the same time, all visible on the dashboard: Crew 1 has installed 900+ LF for three consecutive months; backlog has exceeded four weeks for two consecutive weeks; and cash is above two months of overhead (about \$23,400). In the base case that is month 7. If demand lags, the date moves and nothing is lost.

Step	What	Cost / timing	Safeguard
1. Lead	Promote Crew 1's best hand to Crew 2 lead; hire two laborers at \$20-22	Hiring + 2 weeks shadowing: \$4,500 one-time	Readiness gate and breakdown flow let a lead run a job without Charlie on site
2. Equipment	Buy the trailer (\$9.5K), a used 3/4-ton truck (\$35K) and tools (\$6K) at start; rent a 3.5-4 ton mini-ex (~\$2,000/mo) and a skid steer (~\$1,700/mo) for the first 90 days	Month 7: \$10,100 down; ~\$3,700/mo rent	No machine loans until Crew 2 proves it; live rental rates and on-hand in the app
3. Own	Buy the used mini-ex (~\$50K) and skid steer (~\$38K), 80% financed over 60 months; Crew 2 now owns the same set Crew 1 has	Month 10: \$17,600 down; all loans ~\$2,300/month; paid off month 70	Only after Crew 2 hits 900 LF twice; otherwise keep renting
4. Marketing	LSA and Meta budgets x1.6 from Crew 2's start month	\$1,500 -> \$2,400 paid + \$300 content	Cost per job by channel on the Monday dashboard; cut what does not convert
5. Territory	Split the 20-mile circle: Crew 1 south/east (70808, 70810, 70817, Prairieville), Crew 2 north/west (Central, Zachary, Port Allen)	Parish landing pages go live the same month	Less windshield time per LF - the second productivity lever

The productivity lever nobody talks about: at \$22.50/hr the difference between 900 and 1,000 LF a month is three points of margin. Trucks that leave loaded, machines that do not sit broken, and quotes that do not need a second visit are worth more than a price increase.

Equipment: from renting to owning Crew 2's set

Crew 2 item	Buy price	Rent / mo	Months rented	Rent paid first	Bought in month	Down (20%)	Loan / mo	Paid off	Own beats rent after
Mini excavator (used)	\$50,000	\$2,000	3	\$6,000	month 10	\$10,000	\$830	month 70	25 months
Skid steer / CTL (used)	\$38,000	\$1,700	3	\$5,100	month 10	\$7,600	\$631	month 70	22 months
Dump trailer 7x14 (new)	\$9,500	\$600	0	-	month 7	\$1,900	\$158	month 67	16 months
Truck 3/4-ton (used)	\$35,000	-	0	-	month 7	\$7,000	\$581	month 67	n/a
Tools, laser, compactor, PPE	\$6,000	-	0	-	month 7	\$1,200	\$100	month 67	n/a
Total	\$138,500			\$11,100		\$27,700	\$2,300		

The timeline

- **Month 7 - Crew 2 starts.** Buy what is cheap and holds value (trailer, truck, tools: \$10,100 down). Rent the two machines (~\$3,700/month) from the yard the app shows has them on hand.
- **Months 7-9 - prove it.** Crew 2 must hit its target LF in two consecutive months. Rent paid in this window (\$11,100) is the price of not owning a machine for a crew that did not work out.
- **Month 10 - own it.** Buy the used mini-ex and skid steer, 80% financed: \$17,600 down, then ~\$2,300/month for everything, paid off in month 70. From month 10 both crews run identical, owned sets.
- **Why own at all:** a \$50,000 mini-ex vs. \$2,000/month rent breaks even at 25 months; the skid steer at 22. Anything a crew will run for two years should be owned - and it outlasts the loan by years. Renting is a 90-day insurance policy, not a strategy.
- **Cash check:** the month-10 down payment is the only month in the plan with a materially negative swing, and the balance never drops more than a few thousand below the opening \$25,000 (Proforma tab, 'Cash balance').

The proforma, summarized

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Year 1	Q5-Q6	Q7-Q8	Year 2
Linear feet installed	1,500	2,400	4,600	5,400	13,900	10,800	10,800	21,600
Install revenue	\$103,116	\$127,186	\$249,023	\$270,419	\$749,744	\$540,837	\$540,837	\$1,081,674
Drain Check revenue	\$89	\$875	\$2,157	\$3,754	\$6,875	\$11,917	\$16,775	\$28,692
Total revenue	\$103,205	\$128,061	\$251,181	\$274,173	\$756,620	\$552,754	\$557,612	\$1,110,366
Direct costs (labor, materials, fuel, visits)	\$62,360	\$67,395	\$133,835	\$138,563	\$402,154	\$278,366	\$279,731	\$558,097
Gross profit	\$40,845	\$60,666	\$117,345	\$135,610	\$354,466	\$274,388	\$277,881	\$552,269
Overhead incl. owner draw, marketing, Crew 2	\$34,500	\$35,100	\$55,916	\$44,700	\$170,216	\$89,400	\$89,400	\$178,800
Operating profit	\$6,345	\$25,566	\$61,429	\$90,910	\$184,250	\$184,988	\$188,481	\$373,469
Cash balance, end of period	\$28,752	\$53,756	\$102,180	\$175,240	\$175,240	\$360,228	\$548,709	\$548,709

Scenario (month-24 run rate)	Conservative	Base - Charlie's goal	Stretch
LF per crew / crews / \$ per LF	700 / 1 / \$38	900 / 2 / \$42	1,000 / 2 / \$46
Monthly revenue	\$32,330	\$91,868	\$112,905
Operating profit per year (run rate)	\$2,312	\$367,613	\$568,563
Operating margin	1%	33%	42%

Conventions: revenue in month of install; 30% deposit at signing, 90% of the balance in the month of completion, 10% the month after; payroll burden 14%; labor = crew wages x hours x burden per active crew (switchable to a flat 32% of revenue); \$50/LF all-in; other work at \$1,000/crew-day fills days not used by drains; no income tax modeled (pass-through). Owner draw \$6,000/month is inside overhead. Crew 1's equipment is owned (no capex); Crew 2's purchases total \$138,500 with \$27,700 down. The growth-and-operations lead line is left at \$0 - terms to be agreed separately.

Cash flow: how the growth pays for itself

\$23,135

lowest cash balance in 24 months (month 1)
against a \$25,000 opening balance

\$175,240

cash at end of year 1, after Crew 2's rental,
hiring and the equipment down payment

\$548,709

cash at end of year 2 - the buffer that funds
Crew 3, a second jetter, or a buyout
conversation

Rules that keep it that way

- **30% deposit by text at acceptance, balance link the day the flow test passes.** The app sends both; nobody chases a check. Cash arrives the same month the labor is paid.
- **Two months of overhead in the bank before any hire or purchase** (about \$23,400). The dashboard shows the number; the rule is written down.
- **Rent before buy, finance before cash.** Crew 1's trailer, skid steer and mini-ex are already owned. Crew 2's machines are rented for 90 days, then bought at 80% financing over 60 months; total loan payments of ~\$2,300 a month against a crew that produces \$22,096 a month in gross profit is the right ratio.
- **Drain Check is prepaid.** Annual plans are billed at signing or at the visit; either way the cash comes before the cost, and the visits are scheduled into thin weeks.
- **Buy materials off the live comparison, pay in the month of install.** A 10-15% swing in aggregate and pipe across the parish is real; the app shows it before the truck rolls.
- **Open a line of credit while you do not need it** (year 1, when the bank sees the deposits). It is the backstop for a wet spring that books three crews of work at once.

Your proposal template stays. The software feeds it.

Charlie's proposal is the customer-facing document and it is not changing. Scag Scapes Command sits behind it: it answers the phone, books the estimate, takes the Moasure survey, prices the job, produces the numbers and the map for the template, collects the deposit, schedules the crew, buys the materials, asks for the review and sells the Drain Check plan. Every setting that drives this plan is a field in the app, not a line of code.

Step in the day	What Command does	Setting Charlie controls
Phone rings while he is in a trench	Text-back in 60 s with the price range and two open slots; homeowner picks one by replying	Price range, hours, slot times, message wording
Estimate visit	Moasure survey: export CSV from the Moasure app, import into the quote builder - run length, fall and the 1% slope check fill in automatically (built this week)	Slope minimum, waste factor, materials list per service
Proposal	Numbers and BOM go into Charlie's own template; the Moasure PDF (with logo, scale and elevations) is attached	Deposit %, warranty wording, inclusions and exclusions
Sold	Deposit link by text; job requirements list from the survey; readiness gate before the truck leaves	Approval limits, crew assignments
On site	Breakdown flow, live rental and material comparison, call packages	Recovery weights, crew cost per hour, preferred vendors
Done	Balance link, review ask, Drain Check offer, 11-month warranty walk scheduled, referral ask	Timing of each message, plan price
Every Monday	Dashboard: speed-to-lead, leads and cost per job by channel, close rate, LF per crew, margin per job, plan attach, cash	Which KPIs are on the front page

Moasure has no public API (checked Sept 2026); it exports PDF, DXF/DWG, CSV point clouds and images. The CSV import is live in the quote builder now; the next step is a job-record attachment so the survey, the proposal and the flow-test photo live together for the warranty walk.

Data and analytics: what Charlie sees, and how he changes it

Question	Metric on the dashboard	Target	If it drifts
Are we answering fast enough?	Speed-to-lead (median seconds to first text and to first human)	< 60 s text; < 5 min human	The app already texts; check call-back habits
Are the ads working?	Leads, jobs and cost per job - by channel	< \$450 per job blended	Move budget between LSA and Meta; pause a channel for 2 weeks
Are we closing?	Estimates run and quote-to-sale, by channel and by ZIP	70% of estimates (Charlie's number); leads-to-estimate 50% search / 30% social / 65% referral	Look at price-per-LF outliers and quote turnaround; compare to the yellow cell on Assumptions
Are crews productive?	LF per crew per day; jobs needing a second visit; breakdown hours	43+ LF/day; < 5% revisits	Readiness gate compliance; breakdown response times
Are we making money on each job?	Gross margin per job vs. quoted; materials variance	48% +/- 3	Materials price alerts; discount discipline (the app shows margin impact before a discount)
Is the recurring book growing?	Drain Check attach rate; active plans; visits due this month	40% attach; 150 active by month 24	Put the plan back on the proposal first page; warranty-walk script
Are we safe?	Cash balance vs. two-months-overhead rule; backlog weeks	Cash > \$23,400; backlog 2-4 weeks	Backlog > 4 weeks for 2 weeks = the Crew 2 trigger

Changing the plan takes a minute, not a developer

- Price per LF, deposit %, rain threshold, message wording, approval limits, recovery-option weights, crew cost per hour, plan price - all are settings screens in the app. Change one, and every quote, text and ranking uses it from that moment.
- The proforma workbook is the same idea on paper: yellow cells are the levers, everything else recalculates. Charlie's real figures replace the estimates as the dashboard produces them - month by month the model becomes his actuals.
- Reports page exports: leads by source, jobs by ZIP, margin by job, plan customers, provider performance. Every number is traceable to the record it came from - no black box.

Twelve-month roadmap with kill criteria

Quarter	Build	Sell	Measure	Go / no-go at quarter end
Q1 (months 1-3)	Phone, deposit and review links live; price range and warranty published; GBP verified; Moasure import in every quote; Drain Check price and script	LSA on month 1, Meta month 2; every quote through Command; plan offered on every quote from month 3	Speed-to-lead, cost per job by channel, close rate	Go if 100% of leads answered, cost per job < \$500, Crew 1 at 750+ LF in month 3
Q2 (4-6)	Parish pages; YouTube proof library; readiness gate and breakdown flow on the crew phones; warranty-walk automation	Rain campaigns measured per event; reviews to 25+; plan sold at every warranty walk	LF per crew-day, backlog weeks, plan attach	Go for Crew 2 if 900 LF three months running, backlog > 4 weeks, cash > 2 months overhead
Q3 (7-9)	Crew 2 hired and shadowed; mini-ex rented; territory split; marketing x1.6	Both crews fed by the same funnel; commercial intros (HOAs, property managers) begin	Crew 2 ramp vs. plan, utilization of both crews, cash	Buy the machines only if Crew 2 hits 900 LF twice; otherwise keep renting or pause
Q4 (10-12)	Mini-ex and skid steer purchased and financed (Crew 2 now owns its full set); second jetter if plan visits exceed 20/month; line of credit opened	Referral partners (WCK, roofers, gutter companies, realtors); Drain Check to past customers	Year-1 actuals vs. proforma; plan book; margin per job	Decide Crew 3 trigger, price increase (reviews + map justify \$46/LF), or hold and harvest

Risks and the safeguard for each

- **A dry season.** Rain drives demand. Safeguard: Drain Check visits and the referral ask fill dry months; marketing budget is monthly, not committed.
- **Crew 2 does not perform.** Safeguard: rent-first, buy only after two target months; the lead is promoted from Crew 1, not hired cold.
- **Lead cost creeps up.** Safeguard: cost per job by channel on the Monday dashboard; a two-week pause rule; organic share grows every month.
- **Charlie becomes the bottleneck.** Safeguard: the software answers, books, prices and schedules; the readiness gate lets a crew lead run a job; the plan business needs a tech, not the owner.
- **Price pressure from the New Orleans firms.** Safeguard: they cannot bring a map, a warranty term or a 60-second answer. Sell the engineer, not the foot of pipe.

Five years, grown in the safest order

Years 1-2 are the 24-month proforma. Years 3-5 add a third and fourth crew, but only when the gates below are met - the plan is written so that **nothing is bought or hired ahead of proven demand**. Every blue cell on the tab is Charlie's to change; the base case is below.

	Today	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Crews at year end	1	2	2	3	4	4
Linear feet installed	4,800	13,900	21,600	25,650	35,910	41,040
Drain Check customers (year end)	0	69	150	260	380	480
TOTAL REVENUE	\$380K	\$757K	\$1.11M	\$1.37M	\$1.99M	\$2.36M
Gross margin	36%	47%	50%	48%	49%	49%
TOTAL OVERHEAD	\$140K	\$170K	\$234K	\$446K	\$632K	\$646K
Operating profit before growth lead	-\$3K	\$184K	\$318K	\$218K	\$332K	\$502K
OPERATING PROFIT after growth lead	-\$3K	\$106K	\$226K	\$130K	\$227K	\$380K
Operating margin (after owner draw)	-1%	14%	20%	10%	11%	16%
Cash at year end	\$25K	\$103K	\$329K	\$432K	\$631K	\$1.01M
Reserve rule met (cash > 2 months overhead)	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes

The gates - each crew is a decision, not a date

- **Crew 3 (year 3):** both crews at 900 LF for three straight months, backlog over four weeks for two weeks, cash above two months of overhead, and an operations manager in the seat first. Rent-first 90 days, buy after two target months - the same path Crew 2 took.
- **Crew 4 (year 4):** the same three tests plus a full-time estimator, because at 40+ estimates a month Charlie cannot survey and sell alone. If any test fails, the plan holds at three crews and still clears \$130K of operating profit.
- **Year 5 consolidates:** no new crew; price, utilization and the Drain Check book do the growing. Four crews at 900 LF is the ceiling for one yard and one owner - beyond that is a second location decision, not this plan.
- Owner draw rises from \$72K to \$108K over the period, and every year the company still ends with more cash than it started with (before income tax - the CPA sets distributions).

What has to be in place each year to handle the volume

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Crews & equipment	Crew 1 owns its set. Crew 2 from month 7: trailer, truck, tools bought; mini-ex + skid steer rented 90 days, then bought 80% financed (\$27,700 down)	Two full sets owned. Second jetter when plan visits pass 20/month. Preventive-maintenance log on every machine in the app	Crew 3 set, same rent-first path (\$27,700 down). Spare mini-ex rental agreement on file so a breakdown never idles a crew	Crew 4 set. Replace Crew 1's oldest machine from cash; sell or trade the old unit	No new sets. Refresh cycle: one major machine a year from cash; loans on Crew 2's set retire in year 6
People	Charlie sells, schedules, runs quality. Crew 2 lead promoted from Crew 1. Ned: growth & operations lead (fractional)	Part-time office admin / bookkeeper (phone, AP/AR, reviews, scheduling). Crew-lead bonus pool starts	Operations manager hired before Crew 3 (best crew lead, promoted). Admin goes full-time	Estimator / sales (runs Moasure surveys and quotes). Charlie moves to owner: pricing, partners, hiring, the Monday numbers	Bench: one trained lead-in-waiting per two crews; a maintenance tech runs Drain Check full-time (480 visits)
Bookkeeping & compliance	QuickBooks Online with class per crew; payroll service; monthly close by the 10th; deposits and progress billing through the app	CPA quarterly review; job-cost report per job vs. quote; W-9 and COI file for every sub and vendor	Workers' comp audit-ready payroll by class code; equipment schedule with depreciation; line of credit opened while it is not needed	Budget vs. actual monthly per crew; bonus pool paid from the books, not by feel; annual insurance re-bid	Audited-quality books for three years - what a lender or buyer asks for first
Licensing & insurance	GL, auto, inland marine on equipment; residential contractor registration current; warranty terms written into the proposal	Add commercial GL limits for HOA / property-manager work; umbrella policy quoted	Louisiana commercial contractor license if commercial jobs exceed the residential threshold; WC excess reviewed at three crews	Fleet policy for 4 trucks; driver MVR checks on hire; safety program documented (lowers WC rate)	Re-bid all coverage; claims history clean is worth 10-20% on premiums
Marketing	LSA + Facebook, \$1,800/mo, x1.6 with Crew 2; 60-second text-back; reviews to 25+; parish pages; rain campaigns	Referral partners (roofers, gutters, realtors, WCK); Drain Check to every past customer; YouTube proof library; ~3% of revenue	5% of revenue (~\$69K) - add Nextdoor, HOA newsletters, Ascension/Livingston pages; price to \$52/LF on the strength of reviews and the map	Brand spend (yard signs, wrapped trucks, sponsorships); estimator handles volume; \$99K	Spend falls to 4.5% of revenue as referrals and the plan book compound; \$106K
Software (Command)	Leads, quotes, Moasure import, readiness gate, breakdown recovery, sourcing, dashboard	Drain Check scheduling, route days, customer portal, QuickBooks sync	Per-crew P&L; ops-manager views, inventory and machine hours	Estimator queue and territory routing; automated bid playbook on every lead	Reporting a buyer or lender can read; API for any partner

The order matters more than the speed. Admin before the second crew's paperwork buries Charlie; an operations manager before Crew 3; an estimator before Crew 4. Each hire is paid for by the crew it makes possible, and each is on the 5-year tab as a blue cell.

Working with Ned: role, value, and a proposal for discussion

This page is offered for discussion, not as a condition of anything above. The blueprint, the workbook and the software stand on their own. What follows is how I would propose to stay involved so the plan actually gets executed - and how I would want to be paid only if it works.

What I bring

- Twenty-plus years running a five-location retail operation (Pearson's Luggage & Gifts): hiring, payroll, inventory, cash discipline, multi-site management - the same problems a two-to-four-crew contractor hits.
- Builder and operator of software businesses (DealerCommand for powersports dealers, CoachPerfect) and distribution companies (FilmBase Pros, ServicargoExpress): systems, vendors, margins.
- Home-improvement sales at Window World of Baton Rouge - the same 50-75 homeowner, the same in-home close.
- Baton Rouge network: LSU alumni, Rotary, civic boards - referral partners, commercial introductions, and the first HOA contracts.
- Scag Scapes Command - built, deployed, and live at scagscapes.bridgebox.ai, with the proforma and this plan behind it.

What I would own

- **Year 1:** the growth engine - lead response, LSA and Meta, reviews, Drain Check launch, the Monday dashboard; Crew 2 readiness and the rent-first equipment plan; QuickBooks and monthly close set up with the CPA.
- **Year 2:** referral partners and commercial accounts; hiring and onboarding the admin; per-crew P&L; the customer portal.
- **Years 3-5:** recruiting and coaching the operations manager and estimator; financing for Crew 3 and 4 sets; line of credit; insurance re-bids; keeping the books lender-ready.
- **Always:** the software - every setting, integration and report - so Charlie never pays a developer or waits on one.
- Roughly 25 hours a week, on site for the Monday numbers and the weekly crew huddle.

Proposed terms (blue cells on the 5-year tab)

- **Base:** \$60K in years 1-2, \$66K in year 3, \$72K in years 4-5, as a 1099 fractional role. For scale, a full-time operations manager in Baton Rouge averages about \$130K (BLS OEWS).
- **Growth share:** 10% of operating profit *above today's baseline*, paid quarterly from the books. Nothing on what the business already earns; the share exists only if the growth does.
- **90-day start:** month 3 review against the Q1 gate (100% of leads answered, cost per job under \$500, Crew 1 at 750+ LF). Miss it and either of us can end the arrangement with 30 days' notice; the software stays with Scag Scapes at the agreed license.
- **Annual review** against the year's gates; base and share are Charlie's cells to adjust.
- **What it costs, what it returns:** year 1 total \$78K against \$184K of operating profit before it; year 2 \$92K against \$318K.

Set the base and share cells to zero and the plan still works - it just depends on Charlie's hours for every part of it. The proposal is a way to buy those hours back at a price that only rises when the company does.

What the company is worth along the way

\$170K

Today: about \$69K of seller's discretionary earnings x 2.46 (BizBuySell landscaping median, 945 sales 2021-25)

\$734K

End of year 2: two crews, 150 Drain Check customers, documented systems

\$795K

End of year 4: four crews, a manager who is not the owner, \$631K cash on hand

\$1.20M

End of year 5: \$2.36M revenue, 480 Drain Check customers, \$488K SDE

Why this matters even if Charlie never sells

- A business that runs on a dashboard, has recurring revenue, and has a manager in the seat is worth roughly two and a half times its earnings. One that depends on the owner's phone is worth its trucks. Every step in this plan moves the company from the second kind to the first.
- The same things a buyer pays for - clean books, low customer concentration, a recurring book, documented process, a bench - are exactly what let Charlie take a week off in year 3.
- Recurring Drain Check revenue, systems and a non-owner manager push toward the top of the multiple range; owner dependence and thin books push toward the bottom. The workbook multiple is a blue cell.
- Cross-check: BizBuySell's revenue multiple for the category is 0.70x - year 5 revenue of \$2.36M implies a similar range.

Safe scaling is not slow scaling. It is buying the machine after the crew has proven it, hiring the manager before the crew that needs him, and keeping two months of overhead in the bank the whole way.

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